



BOULDER VALLEY
SCHOOL DISTRICT

Board of Education | May 16, 2023

LRAC Process and Recommendations

Enrollment Big Picture

BVSD has been anticipating a gradual decline in enrollment in future years. COVID-related enrollment loss accelerated this decline dramatically. Declining numbers of students can lead to budget reductions, inefficient facility operations and most importantly, a **less comprehensive educational experience for students at schools with smaller populations.**





BOE Worksession

Background

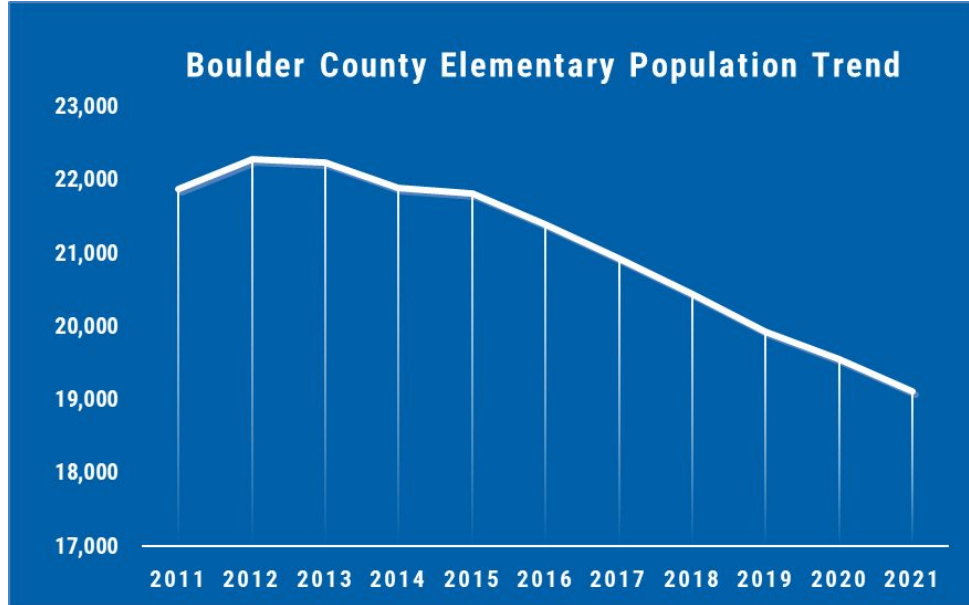
Process Overview

Phase 1: Getting grounded in current state

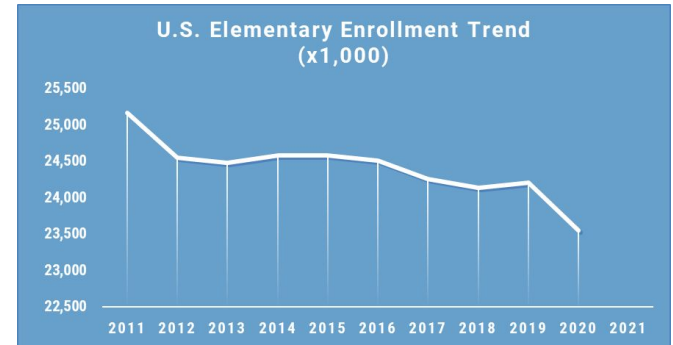
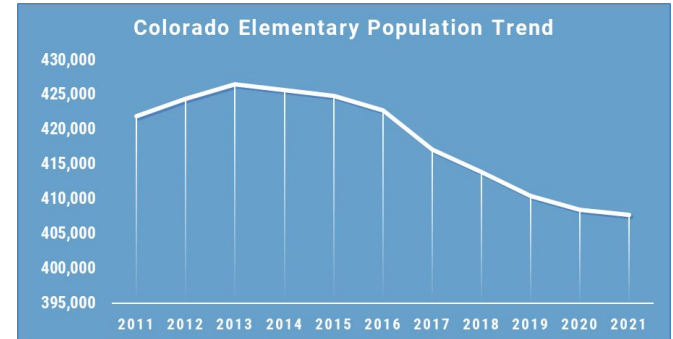
Phase 2: Producing Recommendations



Elementary County, State, and National Trends



Source: Colorado Dept. of Local Affairs & U.S Census Bureau (Current Population Surveys)



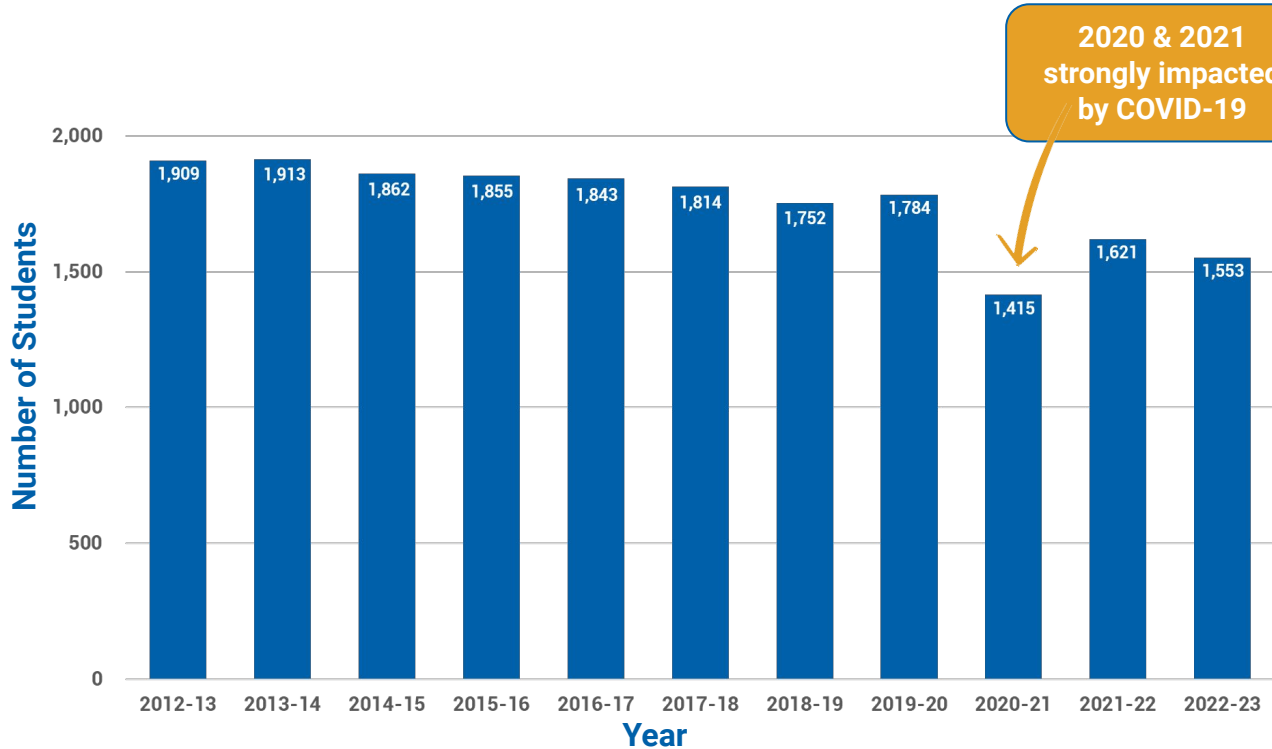
Ten Largest Districts 5-Year Change

District	2021 Enrollment	% Change
Denver County 1	88,889	-3.2%
Jefferson County R-1	78,473	-8.9%
Douglas County Re 1	63,876	-5.5%
Cherry Creek 5	53,558	-3.8%
Adams-Arapahoe 28J	38,451	-6.0%
Adams 12 Five Star Schools	26,078	-7.2%
St Vrain Valley RE1J	32,406	-0.1%
Poudre R-1	29,941	-0.3%
Boulder Valley Re 2	29,011	-7.3%
Academy 20	26,400	+2.2%

Source: Colorado Department of Education

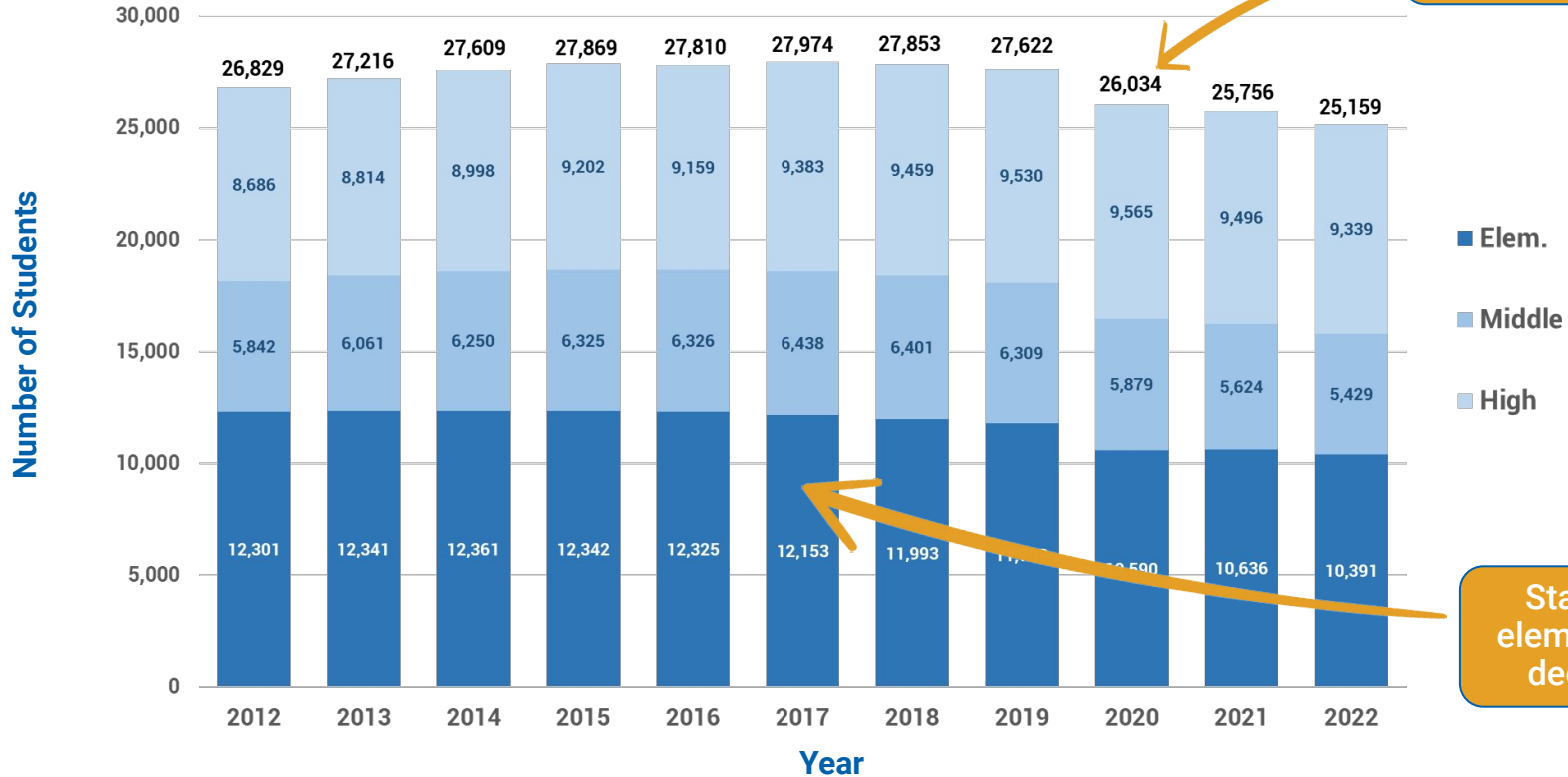


Kindergarten Trend (Non-Charter)



Last 10 Years KG-12 (Non-Charter)

2020 & 2021
strongly impacted
by COVID-19

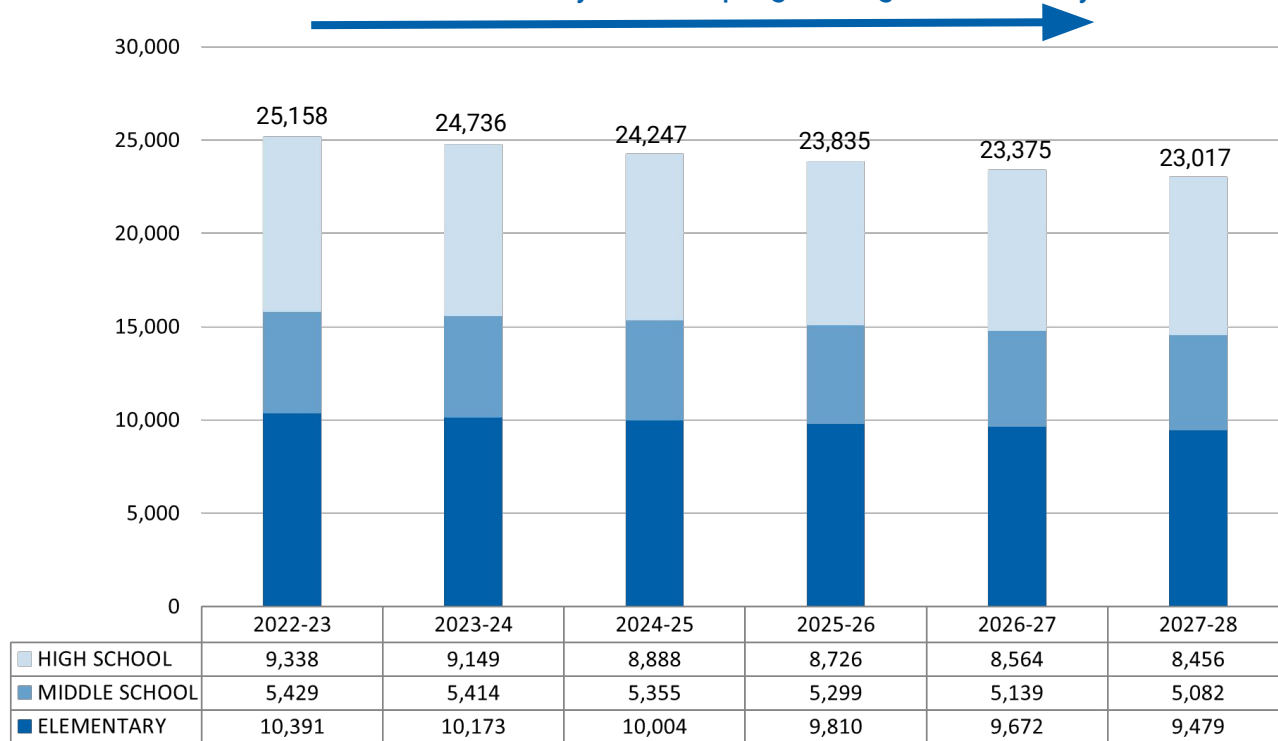


Start of
elementary
decline



5-year K-12* Enrollment Projection (Non-Charter)

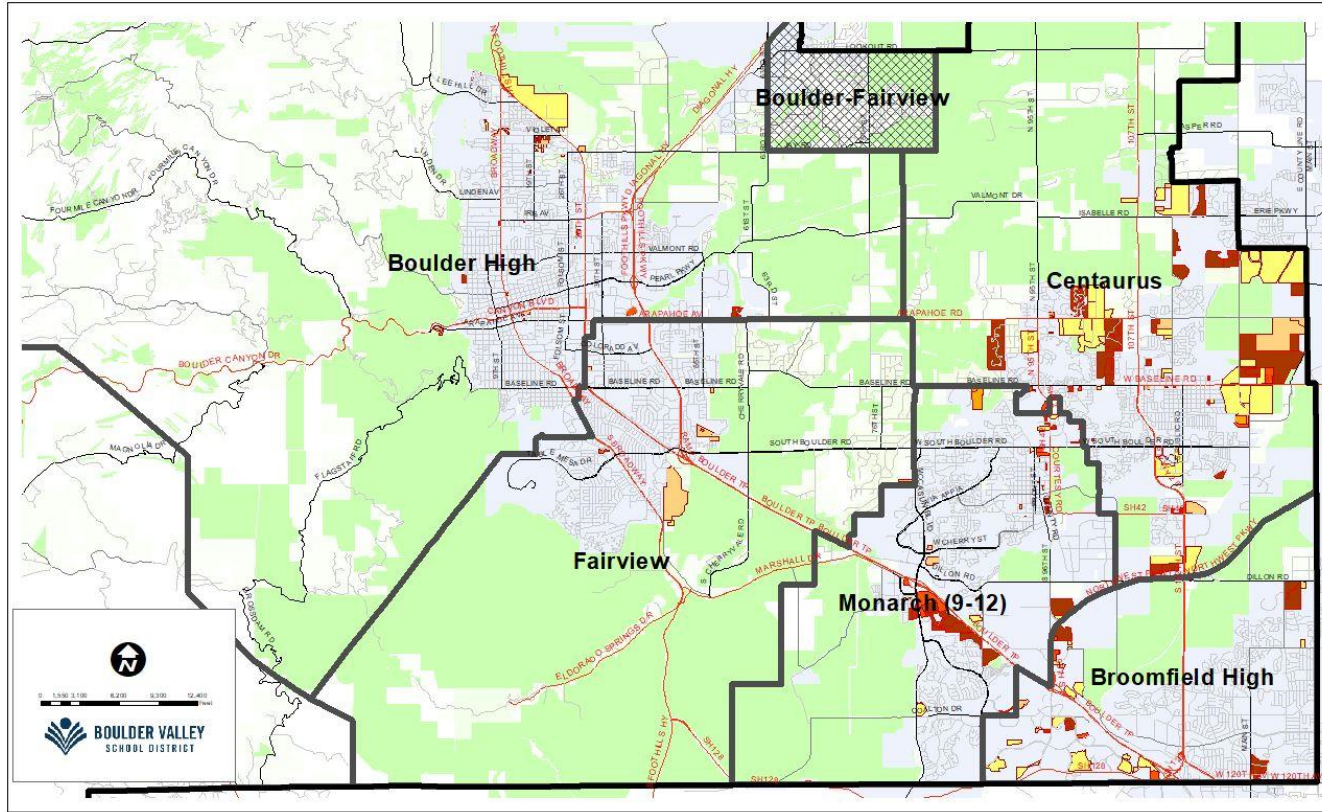
smaller elementary cohorts progressing to secondary



*Preschool not included due to the difficulty to assess demand and due to its disconnect with school attendance areas.



Location of Potential New Housing



All BVSD

El. = 2,824

M.S.= 1,172

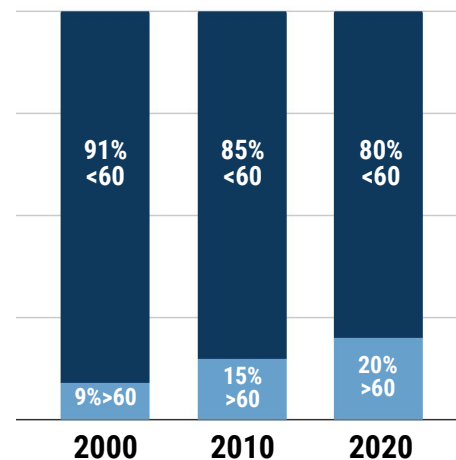
H.S.= 1,653



Causes of Declining Enrollment

- Declining birth rates (national, state, & local trend) & fewer kindergarteners
- Continuing COVID-19 impacts including lower net migration and students shifted to online, private, or other options outside BVSD
- Dwindling housing opportunities due to low inventory, aging population, and high cost
- More housing opportunities in surrounding districts

**BVSD Population Aging
(60+)**



District and School Funding

- The School Finance Act funding formula approved by the legislature determines how much funding each district is allocated based on the formula and student counts.
 - Referred to as “Total Program Funding”
- Local property values determine how much of the funding is generated locally via property tax and how much is provided through state resources.
 - BVSD is 84% local and 16% state funding in the finance act.
- Rising property values do not increase total resources for a school district.
- Declining student counts do not lower property tax bills.
- The district allocates resources to schools based on size, level, programs, student needs and demographics within the total funding available.





BOE Work Session May 16, 2023

The Challenge

LRAC Purpose

To develop recommendations to ensure sound long-term facility decisions consistent with the needs of the school district and in support of the school district's strategic initiatives

What LRAC IS

- An opportunity to develop metrics and guiding principles for the Board to use in future decision making related to addressing how declining enrollment impacts student & staff experiences and district finances

What LRAC is NOT

- A committee to solve declining enrollment
- A committee to solve affordable housing
- A committee to generate marketing ideas
- A committee to address declining birth rates



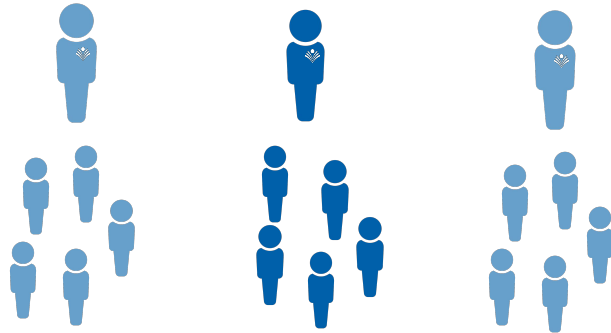
Financial Constraints

- Each 1% drop in enrollment (300 students) = ~\$3M reduction and 12 fewer teacher FTE via the standard staffing formulas.
- As enrollment declines at a school, fixed costs are distributed over fewer students, increasing inefficiencies and the cost per student.
- Disproportionate resources are required to maintain smaller schools, diverting funding from other student and district needs.
- As the number of smaller schools increases, the proportion of the general fund allocated to subsidize those schools grows.
- **The school district's budget is about trade-offs; money spent in one area cannot be spent elsewhere.**

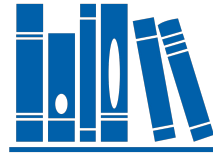
3-Round Elementary Program

3 classes/grade

~450 students



- ABC Specials rotation
- Instrumental music
- Ideal for programming



**Library Media
Specialist**
1.0 FTE



Counselor
1.0 FTE



Special Education
1.0 FTE



Paraeducators
As Needed



P.E. Teacher
1.0 FTE



Art Teacher
1.0 FTE



Music Teacher
1.0 FTE



**Full Instrumental
Music Program**
at 5th Grade



Clerical Support
1.0+ FTE



Principal
1.0 FTE

1.5 Round Elementary Program

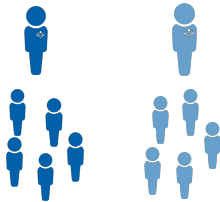
1 or 2 classes/grade

~150 - 225 students

Grade 1



Grade 2



- Traveling teachers
- Scheduling limitations
- Programming limitations



Teacher Librarian
0.5 FTE



Counselor
0.5 FTE



Special Education
As Needed



Paraeducators
As Needed



P.E. Teacher
0.5 FTE or less



Art Teacher
0.5 FTE or less



Music Teacher
0.5 FTE or less



Fewer options for
Instrumental Music at
5th Grade



Office Manager
1.0 FTE



Principal
1.0 FTE

Preliminary Trend by Classes/Grade (rounds)

Elementary Level (excluding mountain schools)

The number of students at each grade in a school along with the staffing ratio for the grade determines how many classes there will be at a particular grade level. This is often referred to as the number of rounds (classes/grade).

	2022-23	2025-26	2027-28
< 2.0 rounds	5 schools	10 schools	12 schools
< 1.5 rounds	1 school	3 schools	3 schools

Enrollment & Financial Delta

	1 Round	2 Round	3 Round	4 Round
Students (max. class load)	172	344	516	688
Base Cost	\$1.59M	\$2.35M	\$3.47M	\$4.40M
Base Per Pupil Cost	\$9,232	\$6,835	\$6,724	\$6,390
Per Pupil Delta vs. 3 Round	\$2,509	\$112	\$0	-\$334
Total Delta vs. 3 Round	\$431,505	\$38,492	\$0	-\$229,474
Marginal Delta	\$393,013	\$38,492	\$0	-\$229,474





BOE Work Session May 16, 2023

LRAC Direction

Developing Recommendations

- Reviewed metrics used by other districts to help inform the work
- Staff proposed metrics and recommendations for committee discussion.
- Metrics aim to identify when the district should consider taking action; determined by enrollment and utilization data.
- Recommendations aim to describe what actions the district might take.



Metrics and Recommendations

Annual Report

Beginning in February of 2024, staff will provide an annual update to the Board of Education regarding school utilization which also includes number of classes per grade level and five-year enrollment projections by school.



Metrics and Recommendations

IF the annual report indicates that an elementary school has fewer than two classes per grade level and enrollment is less than 60% of capacity;

THEN: Tier 1 - Small School Designation

The elementary school operates under the following conditions:

- Resource allocation will adhere to the established staffing funding formula to the greatest extent possible
- Multi-age classrooms may be necessary to meet the funding formula
- Library, counseling, and specials may be limited

Metrics and Recommendations

IF an elementary school's enrollment continues to decline below 50% capacity and fewer than 1.5 average classes per grade level with a projected trend to continue for at least 5 years;

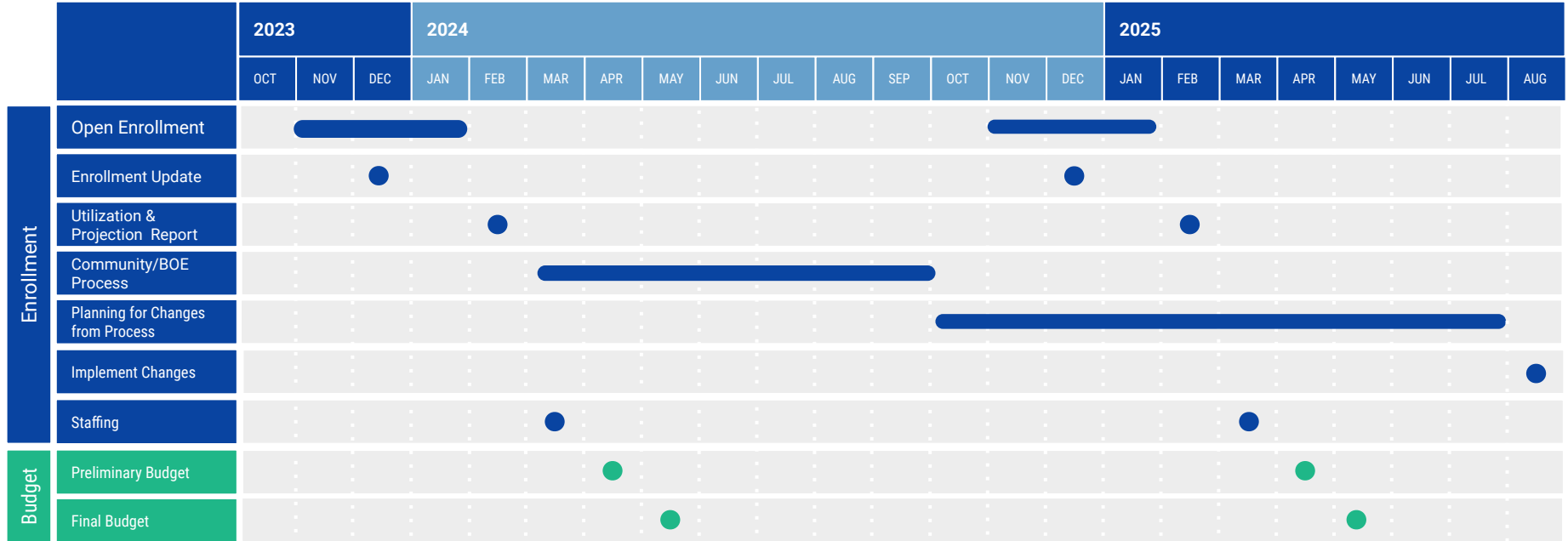
THEN: Tier 2 - Community Engagement Process

The Board will engage staff to lead a community-based process to develop possible solutions to provide a thriving, well-resourced educational environment for students and staff. Decision-making should be in the context of looking at geographic areas or multiple schools if appropriate. Timeline will be established by the Board.

This process may result in recommendations that could include but are not limited to:

- Continuing with “small school” status (i.e. Tier 1 operating conditions)
- Focus or specialized programming
- Reallocate grade levels with neighboring school
- Changes to open enrollment preferences
- Consolidate with adjacent school(s)

Proposed Community Engagement Timeline



Guiding Principles

- Equity and access should be at the heart of every recommendation or decision in the enrollment context. Consideration should be given regarding impacts to historically underserved populations.
- Data should play a significant role in the decision-making process.
- Due to their unique geographic circumstances, mountain schools require differentiated decisions.
- Decisions should aim to maximize efficient use of resources for students across the district.
- It should be understood that change is hard, and communities will need to be supported through any transition.
- Municipalities should be included in conversations about closing or consolidating schools.
- The facility condition and the cost to modernize an existing school to meet educational specifications should be taken into consideration.



Additional Considerations

- Transportation
- Future capital construction/maintenance costs
- Environmental sustainability



Discussion

